from 1993 to 2003, which have proved much harder to reverse when the bad news started coming in from ASER surveys in 2005 onward.

Example 57: Outcomes measurement in the criminal justice system

In each area, it would be wise to start the process of state building with outcomes measurement. The entire enterprise of the criminal justice system should lead to one outcome: young women feeling safe when walking alone in public places at night. This can be directly measured using surveys, where we ask parents the time in the evening when they feel teenage daughters should be back at home. The establishment of crime victimization surveys should be the first milestone in reforms of the criminal justice system.

Episodic versus long-term measurement

Many academic economists initiate a project, gather custom data for that project, and stop measuring when the project is finished. This data is kept confidential by the researcher. While all knowledge is useful, this approach to measurement is less effective from the viewpoint of society.

What is more valuable are methods for measurement which run all the time and which are widely available. When measurement is done all the time, it becomes possible to assess the consequences of an event.

As an example, Andhra Pradesh banned microfinance in 2010. This called for research on understanding the impact of the ban. The Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE) had been surveying 11,000 households in Andhra Pradesh, three times a year, all the time. Households in regions of other states were also observed, where there was no ban on microfinance. This made possible a comparison of regions within Andhra